Passing forward then to the grand results of formation, we are now about to enter upon that peculiar system of organic life which connects the realms of matter and force, and in part reveals the causation underlying the variety of motions which make up the life-principle.

When we turn from the dead body, which is in reality inorganic matter, and contemplate the immense variety of powers and functions manifest in the living structure itself, it becomes impossible to narrow down our investigations to the inert masses examined by anatomy; hence we must push into the avenues opened up by physiology.

To determine the source of those marvellous activities which proceed with such regular order in life, and to ascertain what element it is, the absence of which stills those activities into death, and reduces their instrument of expression to inert matter, has been the problem of ages, and one which even now would not have been susceptible of solution if a partial disclosure of the mystery had not been made by the researches of physiologists, and the light which modern science has thrown upon the powers and functions of the nervous system, under the stimulus of *Electricity*.

For some time past the theory has been advanced, that the hidden and mysterious forces of life were generated by the brain and nervous system in what is termed "*nerve aura*," and that this element would account for all the phenomena vaguely attributed to a "*vital principle*."

The simple fact that the nerves, like the rest of